THE AGE OF THE GUPTAS

📍 NAMES OF KINGS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER ⏳📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Sequence:**
  - Chandragupta I ➔ Samudragupta ➔ Chandragupta II ➔ Kumaragupta ➔ Skandagupta. 👑

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Name / Location 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Imperial Age / Golden Age	The period of about two centuries from the early 4th century CE; known as the classical or golden age of Indian history. 🌟
Fa-hien	Chinese pilgrim who visited India on a religious mission during the reign of Chandragupta II. 🚶
Allahabad Pillar Inscription	Also known as *Prayaga Prashasti*; an important epigraphic evidence composed by Harisena. 🏛️
Harisena	The court poet of Samudragupta who composed the Allahabad Pillar inscription. ✍️
Purusha	The Supreme Being; a title used for Samudragupta in the Prayaga Prashasti. 🕉️
Kubera, Varuna, Indra, Yama	Gods of wealth, oceans, rains, and death respectively (Samudragupta was equated to them). ⛈️
Sri Gupta & Ghatotkacha	The first two rulers of the Gupta dynasty whose history is obscure. 🕰️

Term / Name / Location 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Maharajadhiraja	Title meaning 'king of kings', taken by the first independent king, Chandragupta I. 👑
Kumaradevi	A Lichchhavi princess whose marriage to Chandragupta I formed a vital matrimonial alliance. 💍
Napoleon of India	Title given to Samudragupta because of his bravery and generalship. ⚔️
Dakshinpatha	South India; Samudragupta defeated its twelve rulers but allowed them to rule again. 🌴
Gana Sanghas	Organisation of many kings in the north-west who paid tribute to Samudragupta. 🤝
Ashvamedha Yajna	A horse sacrifice performed by Samudragupta. 🐎
Sakari	Title meaning 'conqueror of Sakas', given to Chandragupta II. 🗡️
Dr. Vincent Smith	Noted historian who stated that annexing Saurashtra and Malwa opened access to western coast ports and European commerce. 🚢
Kuberanaga	A princess of the powerful Naga ruling clan who married Chandragupta II. 🐍

Term / Name / Location 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Prabhavati & Rudrasena II	Chandragupta II's daughter and the Vakataka ruler she married, establishing Deccan influence. 🗺️
Simha-vikrama	Legend on coins showing Chandragupta II slaying a lion (unlike Samudragupta who was shown slaying a tiger). 🦁
Nine Gems	Scholars and literary persons (including Kalidasa, Varahamihira, Amarsimha) who adorned Chandragupta II's court. 💎
Hunas	A barbarian tribe from Central Asia that invaded India for the first time during Kumaragupta's reign. 🏹

📍 THE AGE OF THE GUPTAS (Introduction & Material Progress) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Period of about two centuries from early fourth century CE is known as Imperial Age of the Guptas ➔ established a vast empire comprising almost entire northern India ➔ facilitated by certain material advantages ➔ fertile land in eastern UP and Bihar ➔ iron ore found in Central India and Bihar ➔ which they could exploit to their advantage ➔ material progress thus gained enabled them to make progress in field of literature, art and architecture, science and culture ➔ period is therefore also known as the "classical age" or the "golden age" of Indian history. ✨⚒️

📍 SOURCES: ACCOUNTS OF FA-HIEN 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- Fa-hien was a Chinese pilgrim who visited India on a religious mission during the reign of Chandragupta II ➔ went on a pilgrimage to Mathura, Kannauj, Kapilavastu, Kushinagar, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kashi and Rajagriha ➔ made careful unbiased observations about the conditions at that time ➔ Magadha was a prosperous country with large towns teeming with wealthy population ➔ Pataliputra was a flourishing city with numerous charitable institutions ➔ including a hospital endowed by benevolent citizens ➔ although people were wealthy, they led simple lives generally observing Buddhist rules of conduct ➔ Vaishnavism, Shaivism, Buddhism and Jainism were main religions ➔ however, had no ill-will towards other sects ➔ Hindu gods and goddesses were depicted on coins and also in sculptures and paintings ➔ penal code was mild and offences were ordinarily punished by fines only ➔ from the above accounts, it can be inferred that the Gupta Empire was prosperous and governed on enlightened principles. 📜🏯

📍 **SOURCES: THE ALLAHABAD PILLAR INSCRIPTION (Prayaga Prashasti)** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - It is one of the important epigraphic evidences of the Imperial Guptas ➔ composed by Harisena, the court poet of Samudragupta ➔ written in praise of Samudragupta, arguably the most powerful of the Gupta rulers ➔ describes political geography of India ➔ indicates by naming the different kings and peoples who populated India in the first half of the 4th century CE ➔ describes tribal republics that were conquered by Samudragupta. 🏛️✍️

📍 **EXCERPT FROM THE PRAYAGA PRASHASTI** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - He was without an antagonist on earth ➔ overflowing multitude of his many good qualities adorned by hundreds of good actions ➔ wiped off the fame of other kings with the soles of his feet ➔ he is Purusha (the Supreme Being) ➔ being the cause of the prosperity of the good and the destruction of the bad ➔ he is

incomprehensible ➔ one whose tender heart can be captured only by devotion and humility ➔ possessed of compassion ➔ the giver of many hundred-thousands of cows ➔ mind has received ceremonial initiation for the uplift of the miserable, the poor, the forlorn and the suffering ➔ he is resplendent and embodied kindness to mankind ➔ equal to the gods Kubera (the god of wealth), Varuna (the god of oceans), Indra (the god of rains) and Yama (the god of death). 🐄🌧️

📍 RULERS OF GUPTA PERIOD (Early Kings & Chandragupta I) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - History of first two rulers of the Gupta dynasty (Sri Gupta and his son Ghatotkacha) is obscure ➔ believed that Gupta Era originated with the reign of Chandragupta I ➔ Chandragupta I was the first independent king with the title of Maharajadhiraja or 'king of kings' ➔ after declaring independence in Magadha, extended his empire through matrimonial alliance ➔ married a Lichchhavi princess, Kumaradevi ➔ this event is recorded in a series of gold coins issued by Chandragupta I. 💍🪙

📍 SAMUDRAGUPTA (Conquests & Empire Extent) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - He was the son of Chandragupta I ➔ much information about him obtained from long inscription composed by court poet Harisena engraved on Pillar at Allahabad ➔ was a great conqueror, an able statesman as well as a patron of arts ➔ empire extended from Brahmaputra in the east to rivers Yamuna and Chambal in the west ➔ from Himalayas in the north to Narmada in the south ➔ known as the 'Napoleon of India' because of his bravery and generalship ➔ further extended empire up to Chambal river by defeating Naga kings of Mathura, Gwalior and Ahichhatra ➔ like Alexander he was daring ➔ during famous Deccan campaign he covered more than 3,000 miles through dense forests ➔ defeated many powerful rulers but did not annex southern territories ➔ made the southern kings accept his authority and allowed them to rule. ⚔️🗺️

📍 SAMUDRAGUPTA'S POLICIES TOWARDS FOUR KINDS OF RULERS 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Allahabad Pillar Inscription describes four different kinds of rulers and policies towards them ➔ (a) The nine rulers of Aryavarta were uprooted and their kingdoms made a part of Samudragupta's empire ➔ (b) The twelve rulers of Dakshinpatha (South India) who surrendered after being defeated were liberated and allowed to rule again over their kingdoms ➔ (c) The inner circle of neighbouring states (Assam, Coastal Bengal, Nepal and gana sanghas / organisation of many kings in north-west) paid tribute, followed his orders and attended his court ➔ (d) The rulers of the outlying areas submitted to him and offered their daughters in marriage. 👑🤝

📍 SAMUDRAGUPTA (Culture, Art & Religion) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Performed an Ashvamedha Yajna or horse sacrifice ➔ was not only a brave warrior and conqueror but also a great ruler, a musician and a poet ➔ shown playing the veena on one of his coins ➔ issued eight types of coins made of gold ➔ court was full of great scholars and literary persons ➔ follower of Brahmanism and worshipped Lord Vishnu ➔ had faith in Vedic sacrifices ➔ but was tolerant towards other religions. 🎶🕉️

📍 CHANDRAGUPTA II / VIKRAMADITYA (Conquests & Alliances) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Inscriptions mention he succeeded his father Samudragupta ➔ inherited military genius of his father and extended Gupta empire by conquest ➔ annexed territories of Sakas of Malwa, Gujarat and Saurashtra ➔ given the title 'Sakari' or conqueror of Sakas ➔ Dr. Vincent Smith noted annexation added exceptional wealth and fertility ➔ opened access to ports of western coast ➔ placed him in direct touch with seaborne commerce with Europe through Egypt ➔ entered into matrimonial alliances as part of foreign policy ➔

married Kuberanaga of the Naga family (powerful ruling clan) ➔ marriage of daughter Prabhavati to Vakataka ruler Rudrasena II helped establish political influence in the Deccan. 🌍🚢

📍 CHANDRAGUPTA II (Fa-hien, Coins & Nine Gems) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Chinese pilgrim Fa-hien visited India during his reign ➔ Fa-hien does not mention the name of Chandragupta II in his accounts ➔ but gives interesting information on life of people and general condition of kingdom ➔ issued a wide variety of gold coins like Samudragupta ➔ differences in design: Chandragupta II represented slaying a lion with legend simha-vikrama ➔ Samudragupta shown slaying a tiger ➔ took the title Vikramaditya on many coins ➔ court said to have been adorned by 'nine gems' including Kalidasa, Varahamihira and Amarsimha. 🦁💎

📍 KUMARAGUPTA & SKANDAGUPTA (The Huna Invasion) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Succeeded by Kumaragupta ➔ during his reign Hunas (barbarian tribe of Central Asia) invaded India for the first time ➔ crown prince Skandagupta had ascended the throne at the time of the next attack ➔ gave the Hunas a crushing defeat ➔ they did not dare attack India for the next 50 years. 🛡️🏹

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Role / Concept 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Feudatories	Local kings and smaller chiefs who ruled a large part of the decentralised (indirect) Gupta empire.
Parameshvara, Maharajadhiraja, Paramabhattaraka	Pompous titles (heavy names) adopted by the imperial Gupta rulers.

Term / Role / Concept 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Yama, Varuna, Indra, Kubera	Gods to whom the Gupta kings were compared due to the popular theory of divine kingship.
Vishnu	God to whom Gupta kings were compared regarding their function of preserving and protecting the people.
Lakshmi	Goddess of prosperity who appears on many Gupta coins.
Brahmans	Chief custodians and interpreters of laws who exercised a check on royal power.
Mantri-Parishad	The council of ministers referred to by the renowned poet Kalidasa.
Kumaramatya	High officers forming the chief cadre for recruiting high functionaries.
Sandhivigrahika	Minister of peace and war; an office first appearing under Samudragupta and held by Harisena.
Amatyas & Kumaramatyas	Civil officials who performed military functions or were promoted to the rank of high military officers.
Cavalry	Its growing importance in the military is supported by seals and inscriptions.

Term / Role / Concept 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Shaulkika	The officer connected with the collection of tolls on commodities.
Bhuktis	Provinces (the core of the Empire) placed under the charge of an uparika.
Uparika	A governor appointed by the king in charge of a bhukti (place).
Vishayas	Sub-divisions of bhuktis, placed under the charge of a vishayapati.
Desa, Mandala, Bhoga	Different fiscal (money related) and administrative units, especially in central and western India.
Vithis	Small towns or villages where leading local elements participated in administration.
Janapadas	Various towns that issued their own seals and coins; administered by a committee of five or parishads.
Purapala	Officer under whom the towns in the Gupta Empire were usually placed.
Kulika & Shreshthi	Separate guilds of artisans (kulika) and merchants (shreshthi) found in Vaishali, Bihar.

📍 **GUPTA ADMINISTRATION** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Gupta period saw the gradual disappearance of the Republican form of government ➔ however, unlike the Mauryan Empire, the Gupta administration was decentralised (indirect) in nature ➔ means that feudatories (local kings and smaller chiefs) ruled a large part of the empire ➔ these chiefs and rulers adopted titles like raja and maharaja ➔ whereas the imperial Gupta rulers adopted pompous titles (heavy names) like parameshvara, maharajadhiraja and paramabhattaraka. 🏛️👑

📍 **MONARCHY (King)** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Monarchy was the prevailing form of government during the Gupta period ➔ theory of the divinity of kings became popular during this period ➔ Gupta Kings were compared to different Gods such as Yama, Varuna, Indra and Kubera ➔ they were compared to Vishnu as regards their function of preserving and protecting the people ➔ Lakshmi, the goddess of prosperity, appears on many Gupta coins ➔ Gupta kings enjoyed a large number of powers which covered the political, administrative, military and judicial fields ➔ they were the commanders-in-chief of the army ➔ Samudragupta, Chandragupta II and Skandagupta personally led their armies ➔ kings appointed all the governors and important military and civil officers ➔ governors and their officers had to work under the control and guidance of the king ➔ likewise, the central secretariat (ministry) also worked under the supervision of the king ➔ king was the source of all honours and titles ➔ all land in the country was the property of the king who could give away the same to anybody he pleased ➔ he could construct dams, give shelter to foreigners, impose, recover and remit taxes and give justice ➔ if any property was unclaimed, that went into the coffers (wards) of the king ➔ despite the divine elements attributed to Gupta kings, the brahmans as the chief custodians and interpreters of laws exercised a check on royal power. ⚖️⚔️

📍 **THE COUNCIL OF MINISTERS (cabinet secretariat)** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Gupta rulers had their councils ➔ Kalidasa, the renowned poet, refers to the Mantri-Parishad ➔ it consisted of the prince, the high officials and the feudatories (local kings) ➔ among the high officers were the kumaramatya and the sandhivigrahika ➔ kumaramatyas formed the chief cadre for recruiting high functionaries ➔ some of the kumaramatyas functioned in their own right and maintained their regular office ➔ office of the sandhivigrahika (minister of peace and war) first appeared under Samudragupta and Harisena held this title ➔ main duty of sandhivigrahika was to deal with the feudatories ➔ in addition to these officers, there are references to a dozen other officers engaged in managing military, fiscal and rural matters ➔ growing importance of cavalry is supported by seals and inscriptions ➔ civil officials such as amatyas, kumaramatyas, etc., performed military functions or were promoted to the rank of high military officers ➔ there were officers connected with land transaction ➔ some of these maintained records of land, sales and other records connected with land ➔ revenues (tax / dues) might have been collected mostly in kind but rich peasants probably paid in cash ➔ officer connected with the collection of tolls on commodities is known as shaulkika. 📜💰

📍 PROVINCIAL AND LOCAL ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Gupta rulers evolved the first systematic provincial and local administration ➔ which was primarily concerned with the collection of revenues and maintenance of law and order. 🗺️

📍 Provincial Administration 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - The core of the Empire directly controlled by the Guptas was divided into bhuktis (places) ➔ each of which was placed under the charge of an uparika ➔ uparika was a governor appointed by the king ➔ bhuktis were divided into vishayas, placed under the charge

of the vishayapati ➔ vishaya was divided into smaller units ➔ this pattern, however, was present mainly in the territories directly governed by Gupta kings ➔ elsewhere, there existed different fiscal (money related) and administrative units such as desa, mandala, bhoga, etc., especially in central and western India. 📍

📍 **Village Administration** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Village administration was managed by the village headman ➔ Gupta inscriptions refer to the participation of leading local elements in the administration of the village or small towns called vithis ➔ no land transactions could be effected without their consent ➔ this may have been also true of other important affairs ➔ thus, while villages in Mauryan times were managed from above, those in the Gupta times seem to have been managed from the grassroot level. 🌾🤝

📍 **Town Administration** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - There were various towns (janapadas) which issued their seals and coins ➔ they were administered by a committee of five ➔ some towns were being administered by some kind of parishads ➔ towns in the Gupta Empire were usually placed under an officer called purapala ➔ leading local men (associates) were also associated with the work of administration in towns ➔ such people belonged to the guilds of artisans and traders which flourished during the Gupta age ➔ Vaishali in Bihar was an important town where there were separate guilds of artisans (kulika) and of merchants (shreshthi). 🧩⚒️

📍 **THE GOLDEN AGE OF INDIAN CULTURE** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Gupta period is described as the Golden Age of Indian Culture because of the high level of civilisation and culture of this period ➔ along with the revival of Hinduism, the power of creativity was

unleashed in the fields of education, literature, arts, architecture and science ➔ this period also saw the extension of this influence (related) beyond India's frontiers. ✨🌍

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Nalanda University	Most renowned educational institution of ancient India located at Nalanda in Rajagriha in Bihar.
Hiuen Tsang	Chinese Buddhist scholar who visited during the reign of Harshavardhana and spent five years at Nalanda.
Kumaragupta-I	Emperor of the Gupta dynasty who established Nalanda University as a centre for learning.
Balaputradeva	King of Sumatra who built one of the eight colleges at Nalanda.
Ratnasagar, Ratnodadhi, Ratnaranjak	The three great libraries at Nalanda University.
UN Heritage Site	Designation given to Nalanda in 2016.
East Asia Summit (EAS)	18 member countries collaborating with India to foster academic/cultural exchanges in present-day Nalanda.

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Aryabhatta	Great astronomer and mathematician who flourished during the reign of the Gupta dynasty.
Aryabhattiyam & Surya Siddhanta	Two famous books written by Aryabhatta.
Sushrutha	Doctor and teacher around 600 BCE; known as the 'Father of Plastic Surgery'.
Sushrutha Samhita	The oldest surgical text, covering medicine pathology, anatomy, and surgical management.

📍 NALANDA UNIVERSITY (History & Campus) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - It was the most renowned educational institution of ancient India located at Nalanda in Rajagriha in Bihar ➔ a lot of information about the Nalanda University is given in the inscriptions and in the accounts of Hiuen Tsang (a Chinese Buddhist scholar who visited India during the reign of Harshavardhana) ➔ Nalanda University was established by emperor Kumaragupta-I of the Gupta dynasty as a centre for learning ➔ it carved out its own niche with the support of the Pala kings and later the monks of Nalanda who were patronised by the local chieftains of Bodh Gaya ➔ the University of Nalanda had imposing buildings ➔ there were at least eight colleges built by different patrons including one by Balaputradeva, King of Sumatra ➔ according to Hiuen Tsang the whole university area was enclosed by a brick wall ➔ Nalanda University provided various facilities to the students for their studies ➔ there were three great libraries (called Ratnasagar, Ratnodadhi and Ratnaranjak). 🏛️📚

📍 NALANDA UNIVERSITY (Academics & Legacy) 📌

- **🗺️➡️ The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - The subjects of study at Nalanda University were the four Vedas, logic, grammar, medicine, sankhya, yoga, nyaya and the Buddhist works of the different schools ➔ Nalanda University was not an ordinary university ➔ it was a post-graduate institution to which admission was very difficult ➔ before admission, an examination was held in which hardly 20 per cent students passed and the rest were rejected ➔ only the most brilliant were admitted to the University ➔ at one time, Nalanda's faculty included some of the highly regarded names in Hinayana as well as Mahayana Buddhism ➔ it included Aryabhatta, Harsha, Dharmapala, Nagarjuna, Dharmakirti, Asanga, Vasubandhu, Chandrakirti and Silabhadra ➔ among the foreigners, Hiuen Tsang spent five years at Nalanda during the reign of Harshavardhan in the 7th century ➔ and wrote in detail about Nalanda's meticulous approach in enrolling students, including rigorous admission tests ➔ there were more than 10,000 students and teachers ➔ Nalanda had attracted scholars to its campus from around the world such as China, Japan, Korea, Tibet, Mongolia, Sri Lanka and South East Asia ➔ it flourished for eight centuries until it was destroyed by invaders in the 12th century ➔ it was designated as a UN Heritage Site in 2016. 🙏🎓

📍 PRESENT-DAY NALANDA UNIVERSITY 📌

- **🗺️➡️ The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - The present-day Nalanda University was established as a public research university by an act of Parliament in 2010 ➔ the construction of the new campus began in 2017 and was inaugurated on June 19, 2024 ➔ constructed at a cost of ₹1,749 crore the new campus of the Nalanda University includes two academic blocks with 40 classrooms, accommodating up to 1900 students ➔ besides, it has an international centre, an amphitheatre for 2000 people, a faculty club and a sports complex ➔ a notable feature of this University is the collaborative effort between India and 18

member countries of the East Asia Summit (EAS) meant to foster academic and cultural exchanges among participating nations. 🤝🏛️

📍 SCIENCE: ARYABHATTA 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Aryabhatta was a great astronomer and mathematician ➔ he flourished during the reign of Gupta dynasty ➔ his two famous books include Aryabhattiyam and Surya Siddhanta ➔ his main achievements were the following: (i) He said that the earth moves round the sun (it was several centuries before the Europeans said the same thing) ➔ (ii) He discovered the rule for finding the area of a triangle ➔ (iii) He calculated the exact value of pi which was equal to 3.1416 (the credit for development of trigonometry should actually go to him) ➔ (iv) In his work Surya Siddhanta, he explained the exact causes of solar and lunar eclipses ➔ (v) Aryabhatta was acquainted with the decimal system and use of 'zero'. 🪐🧮

📍 MEDICINE: SUSHRUTHA 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Around 600 BCE, doctor and teacher Sushrutha, also known as the 'Father of Plastic Surgery', carried out highly sophisticated reconstructive procedures ➔ such as nose reconstruction using cheek flaps with the instruments that he crafted ➔ his Sushrutha Samhita is the oldest surgical text ➔ it covers essential principles of medicine pathology, anatomy and surgical management ➔ remarkably, his techniques predate Hippocrates and Galen and the use of household objects and materials, showcase his resourcefulness in a practical setting ➔ His achievements: (i) Established the code of medical ethics ➔ (ii) Emphasised the importance of comprehensive physical examinations ➔ (iii) Described 1120 specific disease entities ➔ he was the first to attribute malaria to mosquitoes and the spread of plague to rats ➔ (iv) Made early diagnosis of diabetes possible ➔ (v) Sushrutha crafted 101 blunt instruments and 20 sharp instruments,

emphasising the fine edge required for their use ➔ (vi) His teachings covered eight fundamental types of surgical procedures, which included extraction, excision, incision, probing, scarifying, suturing, puncturing, and fluid evacuation. 🩺🔪

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Dashavatara Temple	Another name for the Vishnu Temple at Deogarh; one of the finest examples of Gupta architecture.
Shikhara	A tower; the Vishnu temple was the first north Indian temple to have one.
Narasimha and Vamana	Two avataras flanking Lord Vishnu at the front entrance of the temple.
Sheshnaga	The giant serpent on whose coil Vishnu is depicted asleep in one of the temple's nooks.
Nar Narayana	The concept of the fusion of the divine and the human, depicted in the temple's back niche.
Gajendra Moksha	Famous story depicting Lord Vishnu coming to the aid of a trapped elephant (*Gaja*), carved into the third niche.
Sagar Marh	Local name for the temple meaning 'the temple on the tank'.

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Vincent Smith	Historian who compared the Gupta Age to England's Elizabethan period and Kalidasa to Shakespeare.
Meghaduta	'The Cloud Messenger'; an outstanding lyrical poetic work by Kalidasa.
Abhijnanashakuntalam	Kalidasa's dramatic work narrating the love story of king Dushyanta and Shakuntala.
Sanskrit & Prakrit	In Kalidasa's works, higher castes spoke in Sanskrit while lower castes and women spoke in Prakrit.

📍 THE VISHNU TEMPLE AT DEOGARH 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - The Vishnu temple (also called the *Dashavatara Temple*) is one of the finest examples of Gupta architecture ➔ located about 125 km from Jhansi in Uttar Pradesh ➔ it is one of the earliest Hindu stone temples to survive till date ➔ the first north Indian temple with a *Shikhara* or tower ➔ although a part of it has disappeared, in spite of its dilapidated condition the temple has a compelling presence ➔ built on a 1.5 metre high platform with four stairways outside providing access ➔ exterior is decorated with scenes from Ramayana ➔ entrance and pillars are adorned with countless paintings and carvings ➔ front entrance has sculptures of various Gods and Goddesses in moods varying from contemplation to affection ➔ above them is Vishnu flanked by two of his avataras *Narasimha* and *Vamana* ➔ on each of the three sides a niche is made in the wall with dramatic representations of Lord Vishnu's various forms carved into them ➔ one nook has Vishnu asleep on

the coil of the giant serpent called *Sheshnaga* ➔ niche at the back shows the concept of *Nar Narayana* or the fusion of divine and human ➔ the third niche depicts Lord Vishnu coming to the aid of the trapped elephant (*Gaja*) in the famous story of *Gajendra moksha* ➔ unfortunately, the idol of the deity inside the temple is missing ➔ locally known as the *Sagar marh* (literally means 'the temple on the tank') ➔ gets this name from the square water pool cut into the rock in front. 🛕🌀

📍 KALIDASA 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Kalidasa is regarded as the greatest poet and playwright India has ever produced ➔ Vincent Smith compared the Gupta Age with the Elizabethan period in the history of England ➔ according to him, all lesser lights in India are outshone by the brilliancy of Kalidasa just as all smaller authors in England are overshadowed by Shakespeare ➔ his four poetic works are *Ritusamhara*, *Raghuvamsa*, *Meghaduta* and *Kumarasambhava* ➔ the *Meghaduta* (the Cloud Messenger) is an outstanding lyrical poetic work ➔ his three dramatic works were *Vikramorvashiyam*, *Malavikagnimitram* and *Abhijnanashakuntalam* ➔ *Abhijnanashakuntalam* narrates the love story of king Dushyanta and Shakuntala whose son Bharata later became the ruler ➔ a notable feature of Kalidasa's works is that characters belonging to higher castes speak in Sanskrit while those of lower castes and women speak in Prakrit ➔ this shows that the status of women declined during the Gupta period ➔ all works of Kalidasa (specially dramatic works) have been translated into many major languages of the world ➔ although the subject-matter of his works is love, nature and beauty, they nevertheless give reliable information about the government, society and religion of the Gupta period ➔ besides, they also contain traces of political history. ✍️📖